

Freelancer & Self-Employed Tracker

Setup & User Guide · Freelancers · 1099 contractors · solo service businesses · IRS Schedule C ready
· works in Excel & Google Sheets

What you bought

A single, formula-driven spreadsheet that does your freelance / self-employed bookkeeping for you. Log each transaction once, and the workbook automatically organizes everything into a tax-ready **IRS Schedule C** summary and a live profit dashboard — per client. No subscriptions, no logins, no monthly fees. It's yours forever.

The 6 tabs

Tab	What it's for
Start Here	A one-page overview and tips. Read this first.
Setup	Type your client names (up to 5). Everything else links to them automatically.
Transactions	Your logbook. Add one row per income or expense. The only tab you touch daily.
Categories	Reference list of every category and its matching Schedule C line. Feeds the dropdowns.
Schedule C Summary	Fills itself in. Every expense mapped to the correct Schedule C line, per client.
Dashboard	Live totals: net profit, income vs. expenses, by client and by month.

Get started in 4 steps

- **1. Name your clients.** Open the **Setup** tab and type each client name in column B (replace the sample names). You can have up to 5.
- **2. Delete the sample data.** The **Transactions** tab has 8 example rows so you can see how it works. Once you understand it, delete those rows (select rows 4–11, right-click, Delete) before adding your own.
- **3. Log a transaction.** On **Transactions**, fill one row: pick the Date, choose the Client and Type (Income / Expense) from the dropdowns, pick a Category, enter the Amount. The Month column fills in by itself.
- **4. Read your reports.** Open **Schedule C Summary** and **Dashboard** any time — they update the instant you add a row. Nothing to refresh.

How to log it the right way (important)

- **Log every client payment as income** (*Client payment / invoice*) and tag it to that client on the Setup tab — the dashboard then shows revenue per client, your most useful number.

- **Tag client-specific costs to that client** (e.g. a subcontractor hired for one project). Put general overhead — software, phone, insurance — under **(General / overhead)** so it isn't double-counted against a single client.
- **Set aside for quarterly taxes.** This tracker shows your *profit*; as a 1099 / self-employed worker you generally owe estimated tax on it every quarter. A common rule of thumb is to park ~25–30% of profit aside — ask your tax pro for your exact number.
- **Mileage and the home-office deduction are figured separately** by the IRS (standard mileage rate / Form 8829). Keep a mileage log and your home-office details — this sheet covers your direct business expenses.

Use it in Excel or Google Sheets

Excel / Numbers: just open the .xlsx file.

Google Sheets: go to Google Drive → New → File upload → select the .xlsx. Then open it and choose *File* → *Save as Google Sheets*. All formulas, dropdowns and reports carry over.

Each tax year

Keep one file per year. At the start of a new year, make a copy and rename it (e.g. “Freelancer & Self-Employed Tracker 2027”), then clear the Transactions rows. Your prior year stays untouched for your records.

Disclaimer. This template is a bookkeeping organizer, not tax, legal, or accounting advice. The Schedule C line mapping is provided for convenience only. Tax rules vary by situation and jurisdiction — always confirm your specific filing with a qualified tax professional before submitting. Made with spreadsheet software; design and formulas by the seller.